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General Comment

I work in the arts and have friends in education. Over the last few years, we've watched so-called AI (predictive algorithms) disrupt students' ability to learn and think, persuade companies that they can replace essential functions (and jobs) with low-quality AI emulations, and add a staggering burden to our energy grid. These systems add nothing to our quality of life as a nation - their only function is to enrich the select elite few. In fact, they are an active detriment to society in almost all arenas.

As an artist, I'm not threatened by the output of what "AI" produces - low-quality sludge spewed out by a soulless plagiarism machine. It does however make my profession harder in myriad ways that I honestly struggle to enumerate because they are so all-encompassing. A swamp of AI-produced images and low-quality products, churned out solely to make money at the expense of consumers who don't know what they're buying, pollute the waters of the artistic marketplace, as well as make it difficult to collect the high-quality reference materials I need for my art. It is designed to steal the output of hard-working, lower-income artists to enrich jaded technocrats. And yet for all that it impacts my career, far worse is the drain on energy it produces - the already strained Texas energy grid warned yet again of possible energy blackouts, with the added burden of AI sapping yet more of our desperately-needed energy. The global cost on the environment is high. It must be regulated out of existence.

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